

Unforgiveness Kills Your Finances

Prosperity Is Grace, and Unforgiveness Violates the Grace That Supplies

I was meditating and praying, and the Lord began to talk to me again. I had what could be labeled as one of those Pentecostal fits. Hallelujah.

We have been studying stewardship: being a steward over the temporary wealth God has given you and me to administer while we are passing through time and living in this life. Friday night we studied worshiping God and your finances. This morning is going to culminate in communion, because this morning He told me, "I want you to look at forgiveness and your finances."

So this is going to be a fun one.

In studying this, we have had a key Scripture that we have referred to in every service:

For ye know the grace of our Lord Jesus Christ, that, though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

2 Corinthians 8:9

Evidently prosperity in redemption had been taught to the Corinthian church in detail. It is easy to understand unmerited, unearnable grace in every other area except finances. We understand that we could not earn salvation. It is getting easier for those who have studied healing to understand that surely He has borne our sicknesses and carried our pains. If that was a substitutionary act by Jesus, then even healing cannot be earned.

But because there is an instruction that accompanies grace concerning prosperity, and that instruction is giving, it is easy to jump on the bandwagon and turn the grace of giving into a program of legalistic dos and don'ts. Yet Paul proclaimed it by the unmerited, unearnable favor of Jesus:

Though he was rich, yet for your sakes he became poor, that ye through his poverty might be rich.

"Though he was rich" refers once again to the opulence of heaven, the extravagant wealth of heaven that He left. He left that place on a journey with the purpose of becoming not only my sin, but my poverty. He sank to the lows of the depravity of humanity that I might be exalted into the substitutionary truth of His standing for me.

In Psalm 22, when He cried, "I am a worm, and no man," He was speaking of the levels of depravity into which He had sunk when He took my place.

He left that place of opulence on a journey to become my poverty. Now He says that through His poverty, because He substituted Himself in my poverty, I inherit that place. This is what makes it grace. Whether I ever give one dollar to the gospel on my journey through time, I am still saved by grace. When I go to be with the Lord, I am still going to inherit the abundant supply of heaven, because by an act of grace He died for me that I might inherit that place.

What makes it so interesting is to know that I am a citizen of the kingdom of God and that I also have access to the abundance of heaven by faith. Now that I am beginning to understand this grace more and more, I no longer give trying to earn a standing that I could only have by grace. I give as an instruction of grace because, by the power of the Holy Spirit, I already understand that He has made me rich.

By faith we have access into this grace wherein we stand. Even God's prosperity is accessible only by faith in His grace. What grace? That though He was rich, yet for your sakes He became poor. Only by faith do I have access into this grace wherein we stand.

Therefore, even when you give your legalistic tithes and your legalistic dollars, if you violate grace, you hinder your prosperity.

Friday night we taught and preached on worship in that grace of giving. It is hard to worship God to any degree and remain in any degree of poverty. When you practice His presence daily, not just in church when we are led into corporate worship, but when you close the door behind you and nobody is around to see what you are doing, you lift your hands before God and begin to praise and worship Him.

He told you to do that in the middle of every kind of trial:

Count it all joy when ye fall into divers temptations.

It is hard to stay in a bad attitude, depressed, full of care, or full of fear when you lift your hands before God and worship Him daily in the privacy of your prayer closet. If you give God any amount of time at all, pretty soon He will come to your house. If you worship Him, He will heal your body. If you worship Him, He will get your kids off dope. If you worship Him, He will come to your house when you are so broke you are making flour cakes, and He will give you some money.

Worship deals with attitude. If there is one thing a person will get into when income is cut, it is care, worry, and fear.

But because we have faith into this grace wherein we stand, even concerning finances, one of the quickest ways you can cut your finances off is to walk in unforgiveness. Unforgiveness, hatred, and strife violate the very principles by which you and I were born again.

We did not merit it. We did not deserve it. We did not earn it. We were on the other side of a void. We had absolutely no access to God, but He so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son. He crossed that void with His blood. When we were unlovely and unlovable, He presented the blood for us to approach the throne room of grace with.

When you did not deserve it, merit it, or earn it, by His mercy He went to the cross and gave you something to bargain with: the blood of Jesus, giving you the right to approach God and say, "I want to be born again." You did not deserve it. You did not merit it. Yet He extended that grace to you.

When you get into the ugliness of unforgiveness and strife, you violate the very principles by which, when you were quite unlovely, He extended His love to you.

Do you want to cut your finances? Walk in unforgiveness. Walk in malice. Walk in strife. You can legalistically tithe until the cows come home, but you have tied God's hands if you think that bitterness is worth the price.

Someone says, "Well, I walk in bitterness and strife, and I do quite well."

Sure you do. That is because you live in a country that is doing quite well. But if the devil ever decides to eat your lunch, outside of repentance there is not a thing this side of hell you can do about it. And about the time you turn around and start giving like crazy again, he will decide it is time to eat your lunch.

So this morning, let us take a little trip and look at forgiveness and love.

Luke 6:38 Belongs to Mercy, Forgiveness, and the Way We Treat Sinners

Of course, we know Jesus is talking about building your house on the rock, and that every tree is known by its own fruit. So let us go to Luke 6:36:

Be ye therefore merciful, as your Father also is merciful.

Judge not, and ye shall not be judged: condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned: forgive, and ye shall be forgiven:

Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over, shall men give into your bosom.

"Therefore" means He is concluding what He has already taught. Verse 36 and 37 summarize how you and I are supposed to treat the sinner by extending mercy to him.

For the outline of how we are supposed to treat him, go back to verse 27:

Love your enemies, do good to them which hate you.

Instead of retaliating with judgment and hate, verse 37 sums it up by saying:

Judge not, and ye shall not be judged.

"Condemn not, and ye shall not be condemned" is equivalent to verse 28:

Bless them that curse you, and pray for them which despitefully use you.

Instead of condemning them in return, He is saying, "Why can you not extend the blood of Jesus across that void and have mercy on that sinner? Bless him instead of despitefully using him."

Then verse 29 is equivalent to "Forgive, and ye shall be forgiven":

Unto him that smiteth thee on the one cheek offer also the other; and him that taketh away thy cloak forbid not to take thy coat also.

If a man smites you on one cheek and sues you for your coat, what is the equivalent in verse 37? Forgive, and you shall be forgiven.

You are the one having mercy on him. He slaps you so hard your teeth ring, and Jesus says, "Turn the other cheek." You are extending the mercy of Jesus across that void.

Now we approach a difficult one:

Give to every man that asketh of thee; and of him that taketh away thy goods ask them not again.

It may interest you to know He is talking about a lawsuit. What is the equivalent of that in verse 38?

Give, and it shall be given unto you.

The only way we have often used Luke 6:38 is in a service when we are about to take an offering. It holds true there too, but in this passage He is talking about the same measure you measure out in every situation. God will measure it back to you again, and in this verse He is talking about using men to do it.

The golden rule is also in this chapter:

As ye would that men should do to you, do ye also to them likewise.

You have no guarantee that the same sinner who slapped you will turn around and extend mercy to you. You have no guarantee that the man suing you for your coat will extend mercy back to you when you give more than he asked for. But God is kind to the unthankful and the evil. Therefore, be merciful as He is merciful.

He is asking you and me to extend Jesus' mercy across that void to the sinner. When he sues me and I give him more than he sued me for, I am presenting the blood of Jesus to him on a golden platter. I am being blessed by God to extend the blood of Jesus across that void.

If you sue me and take my goods out the back door, do not worry about it. God is heaping it down, running it together, pressing it down, and causing a hundred people to load a camel train with more wealth than you can shake a stick at. They are beginning their journey to my house at the same time you are taking goods out the back door. They will arrive at the front door.

If God can use me to extend mercy to the sinner, He will heap it down, shake it together, press it down, and cause men to give back into my bosom.

As I would that men should do to me, I do to them likewise. Exactly the same way I treat you under every circumstance, that is how God is going to end up treating me. So I really do not care how you treat me, but I do care how He treats me.

That is why Jesus could end by saying that if you build your house on the rock, it will stand. Two storms are going to come. They will come to the man whose foundation is on sand and to the man whose foundation is on the rock. The rock is doing His sayings.

I revere every saying Jesus ever said, but the sayings He is talking about here are foundational sayings. The man digs the debris away and looks for the rock. These are foundations for living, foundations for being blessed by God. They are not necessarily your great mountain-moving verses and exploit verses of faith. They are foundational verses. When the storm has blown through your life, and He guaranteed it would come, this man dug deep into doing Jesus' sayings.

These kinds of sayings are not found lying on top of the ground. You dig for them. Nobody wants to preach them. Nobody wants to live by them.

Why? Because they do not believe God.

"Well, I believe God."

No, you do not. If you believed God, you would believe that the final outcome of any situation you gave to Him would be far greater than the temporary outcome you could get by suing the man's pants off. But because you cannot believe that, you sue, because every tree is known by its own fruit. That is what is working in your heart.

The greatest in the kingdom of God is the man who kept all His sayings and taught men to keep them. The least in the kingdom is still in the kingdom, but he breaks them and teaches men to do so.

Breaking these and teaching that it is all right to break them may seem fine while you are riding high in a prosperous society with good doctors. But let some disease come along and it will eat your lunch like you were broke. The same principles apply in stalking the devil in grace and mercy as apply in finances. With sickness, you often feel you have no choice. You conform to the Word or die.

I would rather conform to the Word by my own free moral agency, not because some devil forced me to bow my knee for three months. I will not give him the time of day. The only thing I say to him is, "Get out." No devil is going to force me to bow my knee to God and scream for help. I bowed my knee to God before he came along. I do it because I love God.

I do not sue people because I love God. I extend mercy across that void because I love God.

Now, when it comes to a Christian, that is another story. I am talking about sinners. I would not do a Christian any favor by feeding him if he refuses to work. The Bible says if he will not work, neither shall he eat. So I test the water to see how badly they want to eat.

In Medford, Oregon, I finally had to get wise. Professional fundraisers come through churches. By the time they finish visiting the churches, they leave with two or three thousand dollars in their pocket. They have a hard-luck story in every office. A lot of preachers know it is a scam, but it is sometimes easier to give them fifty dollars and get rid of them. I am not going to give God's money to a scammer. I say, "We have some work. We will give you minimum wage." Even if I have to pay somebody to stay there and watch them work so they will not steal everything, I will pay somebody to watch them work.

Yet if you are a Christian and you sue me, if you come and forcibly take things from me, and if you take it further to a lawsuit, then I will give you my goods. I may not like it. But even if you are a Christian, I will end up giving you my goods, because I will not lift a finger against you. I simply will not.

It is forgiveness in giving.

Ultimately, by faith we have access into this grace wherein we stand. I know that His standing is accessed by faith, and I will not violate the grace that activates God concerning my prosperity with unforgiveness.

Judge not, and you will not be judged. Condemn not, and you will not be condemned. Forgive, and you shall be forgiven. Give, and it shall be given.

Many of you have given legalistically all your life. When you step into grace, you can reclaim the ground you lost while giving in strife, malice, and fighting. The devil is the one who has locked your finances up, and he can only hold them back so long when you start putting pressure on him by grace.

That is what Paul meant when he said, "I will rejoice in the middle of my infirmities, testings, and trials, for when I am weak, then am I strong." My rejoicing trades my miserable standing for His. When I am weak, I am strong because it switches my dependency off the flesh and onto the Spirit. Then the power of Christ rests upon me because it activates His grace.

That is what God was talking about when He told Paul, even under the attack of the strong man, "My grace is sufficient."

Almost everywhere you go, He connects a giving verse with forgiveness or grace. Forgive your debtors as He forgives your debts. If you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will forgive you.

When you forgive from your heart every man his trespasses, your heavenly Father will forgive you, but He is saying more than that. He will activate grace. He will put a healing balm into the problem caused by strife. If part of that problem is lack of finances, you will find it is much cheaper to operate in God's grace than in legalism. By the time you get done suing that man, someone else will turn around and sue you.

Reconciliation Must Come Before the Gift Can Be Offered in Faith

Go to Matthew 5. What a way to culminate this with communion. Hallelujah.

Look at Matthew 5:22:

Whosoever is angry with his brother without a cause shall be in danger of the judgment:
and whosoever shall say to his brother, Raca, shall be in danger of the council:
but whosoever shall say, Thou fool, shall be in danger of hell fire.

Then He says:

Therefore if thou bring thy gift to the altar, and there rememberest that thy brother hath
ought against thee;
Leave there thy gift before the altar, and go thy way; first be reconciled to thy brother, and
then come and offer thy gift.

Then in verse 25 He says something very unusual:

Agree with thine adversary quickly, whiles thou art in the way with him;
lest at any time the adversary deliver thee to the judge, and the judge deliver thee to the
officer, and thou be cast into prison.

The adversary He is talking about there is not first the devil, even though people get stuck on this verse because the devil is also called the adversary. Jesus said, "Agree with thine adversary while thou art in the way with him." In other words, agree with the brother who is at odds with you while it is still in a negotiable stage.

Then He says, "Lest the adversary deliver thee to the judge." The spiritual implication is this: whoever you are in strife with, whoever you are at odds with, you had better come into agreement, even if on your part that agreement is simply to love him who hates you. Otherwise the adversary,

the enemy of all mankind, turns you over to judgment because of your unforgiveness, and you are cast into a spiritual prison and put on bread and water while you have the opulence of heaven as your inheritance.

No, thank you.

"Well, I do not think He is talking about suing."

Oh, really? Go to verse 40:

And if any man will sue thee at the law, and take away thy coat, let him have thy cloak also.

I just love these messages that get quieter as we go.

Why would He say that? Because when you extend the mercy of Jesus across that void to the sinner, you are activating Luke 6:38:

Give, and it shall be given unto you; good measure, pressed down, and shaken together, and running over.

God will cause men to give into your bosom.

Now go to Matthew 6:11:

Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.
And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil.

If you forgive men their trespasses, your heavenly Father will also forgive you. He is talking about coming into your situation and rectifying it. He will get you out of prison. He will give you a miracle overnight. He will heap it down, shake it together, run it over, and give it back into your bosom.

Why? Because you are merciful as your Father in heaven is merciful. When a man slaps you on the cheek and you turn the other one and forgive him, you are extending the mercy of Jesus across that void. God's power gets activated in your situation.

"Well, I cannot do it. I just cannot."

I know, because you do not believe the final outcome will be greater than the temporary fix you can bring by a lawsuit or your own involvement. But he who teaches men to break the least of these commandments is least in the kingdom. He who keeps them is greatest.

The Birds Teach That Giving Is an Instruction of Grace, Not a Payment for Supply

Go farther in Matthew 6 and look at verse 25:

Therefore I say unto you, Take no thought for your life, what ye shall eat, or what ye shall drink;
nor yet for your body, what ye shall put on.
Is not the life more than meat, and the body than raiment?
Behold the fowls of the air: for they sow not, neither do they reap, nor gather into barns;
yet your heavenly Father feedeth them. Are ye not much better than they?

This is one part I had an absolute Pentecostal fit over.

Look again at verse 26. He said to behold the birds. They do not sow. They do not reap. They do not gather into barns, yet your heavenly Father feeds them.

What did I get out of that? I got a Pentecostal fit.

For you know the grace of the Lord Jesus Christ, that though He was rich, yet for your sakes He became poor, that you through His poverty might be rich. Grace is the unmerited, unearnable favor of God bestowed upon you and me. If this grace is also the force by which we appropriate finances, then we have access into this grace by faith wherein we stand.

If I gave a million dollars a day into the kingdom of God, those works would get me nothing as a wage before God. Notice what Jesus said about the birds when He spoke of your worries and cares over your supply in this lifetime. He said to consider them, to meditate on them.

The birds sow not. If I never gave one penny to the gospel, not one red penny, when the trumpet sounds I would still go home to be with God. I would still go to the opulence of heaven. My rewards are not based on whether God has supplied my natural needs. My reward is based on how faithfully I serve God and how many people I help get born again. Yes, giving gets people born again, so reward is connected to giving. But my supply in heaven, the place to live, the streets to walk on, and the clothing to wear are not determined by whether I gave one penny. By an act of grace, Jesus left that place, came here, took my poverty, and I inherited that place.

So He was trying to teach you something when He told you to meditate on the birds. They do not sow. They do not reap. They do not store seed in barns. They fly around and eat.

He said to consider the lily, how it is clothed. It is so temporary that today it exists and tomorrow it is burned as fuel. Yet even Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of these. How can it be that you have no faith?

Even the birds that do not participate in sowing and reaping are fed by your heavenly Father. Are you not worth much more than they? Then why take care? Do you not know whom you serve?

I do not give because I am trying to earn my clothing and food. I give because I have no care. The Holy Ghost has taught me what God has done for me. I understand the opulence of heaven. I understand my access. Like the sparrow, I am integrated into His love, and He has supplied my needs abundantly.

If He feeds the sparrow, though they do not sow or reap, what am I worried about?

So no, I am not going to walk in strife. No, I will leave my offering and go be reconciled with my enemy. Then by faith I will offer it. He said to do that first. If you offer in strife, it does not make much difference, because you have already given your adversary the power to lock your finances up in prison.

Go be reconciled. If they will not be reconciled, then forgive them. It is as simple as that. Otherwise your adversary, the devil, will turn you over to judgment, and you will be locked in prison until every farthing is paid.

Because this thing is by grace, I am not going to violate grace. I am not going to give the devil authority in my life. If common fear and unbelief are dominating me, I am going to get those verses out and meditate on them. I am going to worship God over them for hours until I am like the birds of the air.

God instigated giving so I could set the level of prosperity I want to walk in. I do not care if I am in the back streets of India with one thousand grains of rice. God instigated giving to activate grace. It is an instruction of grace. Even if there is no more rice to be had, God is not limited to geography. It makes no difference what part of the world you are in. The difference is whose Bible you are holding and what is working in your heart.

If a Muslim, a Buddhist, or any other man is starving and I am starving, and I have one thousand grains of rice, I will measure out five hundred of them, go over to him, and say, "Give me your hand."

He will say, "What are you doing?"

I will say, "I have a handful of rice, and I am going to tell you that this handful of rice has come from the only true and living God, who said, 'I am the way, the truth, and the life, and no man comes to the Father but by Me.' This is a love gift from the Lord Jesus Christ because He desires your soul."

Communion Gives the Heart a Place to Renounce Strife Before Offering the Gift

We are getting ready to take communion, and the Lord had me culminate this message today with communion because of what communion has to do with forgiveness. You are going to have a chance, before taking of the body of Jesus Christ, to wipe and totally cleanse your slate. In your heart, you can be reconciled to your Father.

If there is anybody you need to make something right with later, that is fine. But today, before you offer your offering after communion, you can be reconciled to the Father.

Some of you will walk out and get jobs. Some of you will walk out and get raises. Long-overdue blessings will begin to fall out of heaven on you if you are a gospel spreader and a giver.

I am having a good time. Is anybody having as good a time as I am? Glory be to God. I love these quiet messages. It is easier to hear myself think.

Let us prepare ourselves for communion. Go to 1 Corinthians 11:30:

For this cause many are weak and sickly among you, and many sleep.

Many are afflicted with diseases. Many sleep, and the implication is that many got sick and died before their time. He said, "For this cause."

If Pentecostal people are searching for anything concerning healing, it is why diseases come on some people and not others, and why some die of diseases even when you would swear they had faith. In the middle of the most Pentecostal chapters in the entire Word of God, 1 Corinthians 10 through 14, dealing with the operation of the gifts, Paul says, "For this cause." That makes a man want to back up in the chapter and meditate until he finds out what cause he is talking about.

We do not have to go back very far. Look at verse 29:

For he that eateth and drinketh unworthily, eateth and drinketh damnation to himself, not discerning the Lord's body.

Whenever I heard preachers preach on this, they would say that people die of sickness and disease before their time because they do not discern healing in the atonement when they take communion. The broken body represents healing, for with His stripes we are healed. That is true, but that is not really what Paul was talking about here.

Jesus said, "This is My blood, which was shed for you. As often as you partake of this, do it in remembrance of Me." He said, "This is My body, which was broken for you. As often as you partake of this, do it in remembrance of Me."

My question to God for many years was this: if Isaiah 53 says, "With His stripes we are healed," then why does Isaiah 53:4 say, "Surely He hath borne our sicknesses and carried our pains"? I understood substitution and identification. I understood my sicknesses and pains coming upon Jesus when darkness covered Him and He cried, "My God, why hast Thou forsaken Me?" I understood Him becoming every disease I ever was, and because He substituted Himself in my sicknesses and pains, I have a right to His health.

I understood that He was made to be sin for me, that I might be made the righteousness of God in Christ. I understood that He was made my poverty for me, that I might inherit the opulence of heaven and have rights to heaven now. What I did not understand was the statement, "By His stripes we are healed," until He opened Isaiah 53 to me.

Go to Isaiah 53:4:

Surely he hath borne our griefs, and carried our sorrows:
yet we did esteem him stricken, smitten of God, and afflicted.
But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities:
the chastisement of our peace was upon him;
and with his stripes we are healed.

He was wounded for our transgressions. He was bruised for our iniquities. The chastisement for our lack of peace was upon Him. With His stripes we are healed.

Healed from what? Lack of peace.

That is when God told me, "You will find your answer under the law." So I went back under the law and found it in Deuteronomy 25:

If there be a controversy between men, and they come unto judgment, that the judges may judge them;
then they shall justify the righteous, and condemn the wicked.
And it shall be, if the wicked man be worthy to be beaten, that the judge shall cause him to lie down, and to be beaten before his face, according to his fault, by a certain number.
Forty stripes he may give him, and not exceed.

Does that sound like strife? It sounds like strife to me. If there is a controversy between two men, they come into judgment. The judge hears the case, justifies the righteous, condemns the wicked, and the condemned man receives stripes according to the level of his violation.

How many stripes did Jesus take on His back? Thirty-nine. That is forty save one, so they would not exceed the limit of the law.

He was wounded for our transgressions. He was bruised for our iniquities. The chastisement for our lack of peace was laid on Him, and that chastisement took the form of punishment. With His stripes we were healed.

Two men went before a righteous judge under the law. One of them was condemned according to his fault, up to forty lashes. They caused him to lie on the ground with his back upward, and they gave him up to thirty-nine lashes.

Jesus is talking about substitutionary truth. He stepped into my shoes to take the maximum penalty. He stepped into my shoes to receive the judgment I had coming for every controversy, strife, hatred, or malice. He received the penalty under the law, the full thirty-nine lashes, as He substituted Himself in my place in the controversy.

He took the judgment I had coming, so I can stand in the middle of any strife-filled, devil-empowered controversy and say, "No. The chastisement for my lack of peace was laid on Jesus, and with His stripes I was healed. Devil, I break your hold over this controversy by the stripes of Jesus."

Any failure you may have received from walking in hatred, including finances being held up, was also laid on Jesus in judgment. When you forgive, totally forgive every man his trespasses, you release Jesus to minister to you the maximum of what He received for you through redemption.

I understand substitution and identification now. He was made poor, and I have access to His riches. He was made sin, and I was made the righteousness of God in Christ. He bore my sicknesses and pains. The chastisement for my lack of peace was upon Him, and it took the form of stripes. With those stripes, I am healed.

Have you ever wondered what kind of power God would use to bring the body together? When Jesus said, "This is My body which was broken for you," He was saying that His physical body was whipped, broken open, stabbed in the side, and crowned with thorns. His physical body was broken apart so that it would activate those stripes, and when we partake of that broken body, the power of God unites His spiritual body.

His body was broken for us that it might unite the spiritual body and free it from schisms, unforgiveness, hatred, and strife. He was broken that we might be united.

When you take that bread, you are taking hold of His body, represented by the bread, and breaking it. The breaking represents your strife. You tear it apart because the tearing apart of that body is substitution to unite you and free you from hatred and strife with your brothers. When you partake of that broken body, it will unite us.

For this cause many are sickly and many sleep, because they are in schisms and divisions and refuse to free themselves from hatred and unforgiveness. Not only do their finances die, their bodies die.

The Broken Body Ministers Power Against Division, Hatred, and Unforgiveness

Go to 1 Corinthians 10:16:

The cup of blessing which we bless, is it not the communion of the blood of Christ?
The bread which we break, is it not the communion of the body of Christ?
For we being many are one bread, and one body: for we are all partakers of that one bread.

Now go to 1 Corinthians 11:17:

Now in this that I declare unto you I praise you not, that ye come together not for the better, but for the worse.
For first of all, when ye come together in the church, I hear that there be divisions among you; and I partly believe it.

There were divisions among them, and for there to be divisions there had to be leaders of the division. There had to be doctrine with it. Paul said there must also be heresies among you, that those who are approved may be made manifest.

Then he says:

When ye come together therefore into one place, this is not to eat the Lord's supper.

In other words, if you come together with strife, schisms, and unforgiveness, then you are not partaking of the Lord's Supper He instigated, because it simply will not work. It is not the one the Lord Jesus Christ instigated that you are partaking of.

Then in verse 23 he gives the one Jesus instigated:

For I have received of the Lord that which also I delivered unto you,
That the Lord Jesus the same night in which he was betrayed took bread.

That is why he goes on to say, "For this cause many are weak and sickly among you." He is explaining the whole division issue. We are all one body. We are many members of one body. When we break this bread, is it not the communion, the fellowship, of that body?

In a moment we are going to take His body and His blood into our hands. Then we are going to go back to our seats and have a time with the Father. Bare your heart, and remember that you are about to break His body. The reason you break it is substitution, that He might unite us one with another. His power will be activated to break the hold of strife, anger, unforgiveness, and the devil's hold over situations.

I am talking about miracles coming on the scene and you being healed. I am talking about His power getting involved in such a way that it breaks the hold of hatred over you. This is not a feeble attempt to turn it loose. I am talking about administering the power of His broken body over your strife and unforgiveness. He has a way of reaching inside and changing it.

Of course, if you do not have any strife, then you are simply partaking of the communion of this body. You are flowing as an individual member in a vast body, one with each other in the unity of love.

Hallelujah, Jesus.

For in the presence of this peace is joy. When you minister before Me peace and joy, you will find that I will dissipate your cares, and where they once ruled, I will be there. I will take your emotions and stabilize them on the rock. I will take your tongue and, by faith, I will teach you to talk. I will take your life and lose it in Me. I will take your entire being and set you free. I will anoint you with anointings from on high. I will graciously spend Myself for you. When you come to Me, I will draw nigh.

Allow Me to minister to you this communion this morning. Commune yourself with Me. Draw, cleave unto My grace and My forgiveness, and partake of My broken body, that I may minister My healing unto you. I will set you free.

He said, "This is My body, which is broken for you." He said, "This is My blood, which is shed for you." He said, "As often as you partake, do it in remembrance of Me."

Right now, as the Holy Ghost gives you a moment to clear the briars and thorn seeds from your ground, remember that this is the reason His body was broken. But do not go witch-hunting. Do not try to pull things up from your past that you have asked Him to forgive you for a hundred times but are still not sure about. This kind of healing reaches deep within your being and removes the power that thing had over you.

Get ready. Bow your head for a moment in contemplation and meditation.

Father, I stand before You now and ask You to cleanse my ground. There are people who have hurt me, and sometimes I do not quite get over the hurt. My tongue gets a little sharper than it should.

Father, it is almost impossible to stand up under all that in our own strength, but I thank You for the Holy Spirit and for mortification that comes by and through the Spirit. Right now, Father, as I partake of Your broken body, it will unite me once again, not only in fellowship with You, but because this is Your body, it will unite me back into Your grace and fellowship with every person I have ever had ought against.

Glory.

For I have received of the Lord that which I delivered unto you: that the Lord Jesus, the same night in which He was betrayed, took bread; and when He had given thanks, He broke it and said:

Take, eat: this is my body, which is broken for you: this do in remembrance of me.

Take and eat.

Jesus, we remember. We remember. My heart is clean. I forgive. I love everyone. We forgive. We remember. I am healed. My body is healed, Father. My body is healed.

After the same manner also He took the cup, and when He had supped, saying:

This cup is the new testament in my blood: this do ye, as oft as ye drink it, in remembrance of me.

Jesus, we remember. We thank You for Your grace and Your blood that was shed for us. We stand in Your presence now as the righteousness of God in Christ, not just reconciled to each other as Your body, but reconciled to You by this blood.

We remember.

Hallelujah.